

Guide Lovable Site Builder

checklist.

of code — step-by-step prompting, page structure, and launch

Build a professional, branded website without writing a single line

Contents

- 01** Getting Started — Account & Domain Setup
 - 02** How to Prompt Lovable Effectively
 - 03** MAAT Prompt Library
 - 04** Building Multiple Pages
 - 05** Members Area & Access Gating
 - 06** SEO & Discoverability
 - 07** Pre-Launch Checklist
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This guide is built for entrepreneurs using Lovable (lovable.dev) to launch a branded website. Each module builds on the last — follow it in order the first time, then use individual sections as reference.

01 — Getting Started

Account setup, GitHub connection & custom domain

Lovable is an AI-powered site builder that converts natural language prompts into real React/TypeScript code. You own every site it builds — it can be exported, hosted anywhere, or connected to your own domain.

Step 1 — Create Your Lovable Account

Visit **lovable.dev** and sign up with your email. The free tier allows limited projects. Upgrade to Pro (\$20/month) for unlimited projects, custom domains, and full export.

Step 2 — Start a New Project

Click "New Project" from your dashboard. Name it clearly — e.g. "my-brand-site" or "shop-main". This becomes your preview URL identifier. Use lowercase hyphens only — no spaces.

Step 3 — Connect GitHub (Recommended)

In Project Settings → Integrations, connect your GitHub account. Lovable will push every change to a repository automatically. This is your backup and your exit if you ever want to move hosting elsewhere.

Step 4 — Connect a Custom Domain

In Project Settings → Domain, enter your domain. Then go to your domain registrar (Namecheap, GoDaddy, etc.) and add a CNAME record pointing to your Lovable preview URL.

CNAME RECORD

DNS Settings

Type: CNAME Host: @ or www Value: your-project.lovable.app DNS propagation can take 24-48 hours. Your .lovable.app URL works immediately.

02 — How to Prompt Lovable

The 3-layer formula + common fixes

Lovable is an AI. It does what you tell it — but generic instructions produce generic results. Every strong Lovable prompt has three layers:

Layer	What It Covers	Example
WHAT	The section or component you want	"A hero section"
HOW	Visual direction — layout, color, font, spacing	"Dark background, gold headline, centered"
WHY	The user outcome or conversion goal	"To get visitors to click Get Access"

Prompt Rules

- One section per prompt — never ask for the whole page at once on a first build
- Always specify fonts, colors, and spacing — Lovable defaults to generic without them
- End every edit prompt with: "Do not change anything else on this page"
- Use "add to the existing page" rather than "create a new page" when extending content
- Describe tone and feel alongside layout: "editorial," "luxury," "high-contrast"

Fixing Bad Output

Step ■ — Revert + Refine

If a prompt produces something you hate, click the Revert button immediately (before making more prompts). Then rewrite your prompt with more specific language before resubmitting. Never stack bad prompts — always revert first.

Step ■ — Screenshot Prompt

Take a screenshot of a design you like. Paste it directly into the Lovable chat and say: "Match this visual style in a section that does [X]." This is the fastest way to align Lovable's output to a specific aesthetic.

◆ MAAT TIP

Lovable works best when prompts are specific and bounded. Think of each prompt as a single instruction to a professional developer — not a brainstorm session.

03 — Prompt Library

Ready-to-use prompts — customize and paste

These prompts are written around a dark/gold brand aesthetic. Swap out the specific color values, font names, and content to match your own brand before pasting into Lovable.

Hero Section

HERO PROMPT

Lovable Chat

Create a full-viewport hero section with a dark textured background. Center-aligned layout. Headline in a bold display font at 88px: "[Your Main Headline]." Subheadline in an italic serif, 22px: "[Your Subheading]." Two CTA buttons below — primary: solid accent-color "[Primary CTA Text]" and secondary: outlined "[Secondary CTA Text]." Add a thin horizontal accent rule above the headline. Do not change navigation or any other section.

Product Card Grid

PRODUCT GRID PROMPT

Lovable Chat

Add a 3-column product card grid section below the hero. Each card has: a top accent line, a product tier tag in monospace (TIER 1, TIER 2, etc.), a product title in a bold display font at 28px, a 2-line description in an italic serif at 16px, a price in accent color at 32px, and a "Get Access" button. Cards should have a subtle hover border glow. Section heading: "[Your Section Title]." Do not modify any existing sections.

Email Opt-In Section

EMAIL CAPTURE PROMPT

Lovable Chat

Add a full-width email capture section with a subtle gradient background. Centered layout. Headline: "[Free Resource Headline]." Subtext: "[1-sentence value statement]." Email input field with a styled border, submit button in solid accent color with label "[Button Text]." Fine print below: "Sent to [your list]. Unsubscribe anytime." Do not change other sections.

Sticky Navigation

NAV PROMPT

Lovable Chat

Update the navigation bar to be sticky (fixed to top on scroll) with a slight dark background blur effect (backdrop-filter: blur). Keep all existing nav items. On mobile, collapse to a hamburger icon. The primary CTA button should remain a solid colored rectangle. Do not change page content.

Testimonial Row

TESTIMONIALS PROMPT

Lovable Chat

Create a horizontal scrolling testimonial row with 4 quote cards. Each card is 340px wide, has a thin left accent border, the quote in an italic serif at 17px, and an attribution line in small monospace below a dividing line. Section label above in small caps monospace: "[Section Label]." No changes to other sections.

04 — Building Multiple Pages

Site structure, routing, and adding new pages

Lovable builds React single-page apps (SPAs) using React Router. Every URL route is a separate component — Lovable manages this for you. Before prompting new pages, map out your full site structure. Every page should have one clear job.

Common Page Types & Their Jobs

Route	Page Type	Primary Job
/	Homepage	First impression — hero, core offer, primary CTA
/about	About / Story	Build trust — background, mission, and why it matters
/products	Products / Services	Convert — offer ladder, pricing, and buy buttons
/[offer-name]	Dedicated Sales Page	One product, one focus — no nav, pure conversion
/members	Members / Community	Deliver — gated content for paying customers
/blog	Blog / Content Hub	Attract — SEO content, thought leadership, free value
/contact	Contact	Connect — booking form, inquiry, or direct links

♦ MAAT TIP

Name routes short, lowercase, and hyphenated: /the-vault, /start-here, /apply. The route becomes part of your URL — keep it readable and memorable.

Adding a New Page — Step by Step

Step 1 — Prompt the Page Into Existence

Tell Lovable the route, the layout, and the content. It will create the React component and register the route in App.tsx automatically.

NEW PAGE PROMPT

Lovable Chat

Create a new page at the route `/[your-route]`. The page should have `[describe layout and content]`. Use the same background, fonts, and color palette as the homepage. Add the route to App.tsx. Do not modify any existing pages.

Step 2 — Add It to Your Navigation

After the page exists, prompt Lovable to add the nav link. Mention desktop and mobile.

NAV LINK PROMPT

Lovable Chat

Add "[Page Label]" to the navigation bar, linking to /[your-route]. Make sure it also appears in the mobile navigation menu. Do not change any other nav items.

Step 3 — Fix a Blank Page (Common Issue)

A blank screen at a route usually means the component exists but the route is missing in App.tsx. Use this prompt to diagnose and fix it.

BLANK PAGE FIX

Lovable Chat

The /[your-route] page is loading blank. Check whether a route exists in App.tsx for this path. If the route is missing, add it. If the component is also missing, create a placeholder page with the same styling as the homepage and a centered heading: "[Page Name] – Coming Soon." Do not modify other routes or components.

05 — Members Area & Gating

Protect paid content with access codes or Supabase auth

If you have a membership or course, you need to gate the content so only paying members can access it. Lovable supports two approaches: a simple access-code gate (best for launch) or full authentication via Supabase (best for scale).

Method	Setup Complexity	Best For	Limitation
Access Code	Low — hardcoded in the component	Under 100 members, fast launch	Manual code distribution
Supabase Auth	Medium — connect Lovable to Supabase	100+ members, self-service signup	Requires Supabase account setup

Access Code Gate Prompt

MEMBERS GATE PROMPT

Lovable Chat

On the `/[members-route]` page, before showing any content, add an access gate. Display a centered card with your brand logo, a heading "Members Only" in a bold display font, and an input field with placeholder "Enter Your Access Code." When the correct code is entered (hardcode: `"[YOUR-CODE]"`), hide the gate and show the content. If the code is wrong, show an error: "Invalid code. Check your welcome email." Store the validated state in `sessionStorage` so the gate does not reappear on page refresh. Do not change any other pages.

◆ MAAT TIP

Deliver access codes in your post-purchase email via ConvertKit or MailerLite. Rotate your code every 90 days and email the update to active members.

06 — SEO & Discoverability

Getting found on Google

React SPAs are not indexed by Google by default. The HTML that Google sees is mostly empty — the content is injected by JavaScript after load. You need to address this or your site will be invisible to search engines.

Your Three Options

React Helmet (Easiest)

Install react-helmet-async and add dynamic meta tags per page. Tells browsers and social platforms the correct title, description, and preview image.

Netlify Prerendering

Deploy to Netlify and enable prerendering. Netlify will serve a pre-rendered HTML snapshot to crawlers like Googlebot. Free, minimal setup.

Sitemap + robots.txt

Create a public/sitemap.xml listing all your routes, and a public/robots.txt. Submit your sitemap to Google Search Console to accelerate indexing.

SEO Meta Tags Prompt

SEO PROMPT

Lovable Chat

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Install react-helmet-async and add SEO meta tags to each page. For the homepage use: title "[Your Site Name – Tagline]", description "[1-2 sentence description of your site and who it serves]." Add Open Graph tags: og:title, og:description, og:image (use "/og-image.jpg"), og:url "[https://yourdomain.com]". Do this for all existing pages with appropriate unique titles and descriptions. Do not change visual layout.
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07 — Pre-Launch Checklist

Verify everything before going live

- Custom domain connected with SSL certificate active (green lock in browser)
- All navigation links tested on desktop and mobile
- Every page route loads correctly — no blank screens
- Hero CTA buttons linking to correct product/checkout pages
- Email opt-in form connected to your email platform (ConvertKit, MailerLite, etc.)
- Mobile navigation hamburger menu working correctly
- Open Graph image set — test social preview at opengraph.xyz
- Analytics tracking code added (Google Analytics or Plausible)
- Favicon set (32×32 PNG in `/public/favicon.ico`)
- Page load speed tested on Google PageSpeed Insights (aim for 80+ mobile score)
- Members access gate tested with correct and incorrect codes
- Payment links tested end-to-end — add to cart → checkout → confirmation email
- Footer includes legal links: Privacy Policy, Terms of Use
- Contact or inquiry method is visible and working

MAAT — Moor Ascension And Triumph | scrollsofmaat.com | peacegods@scrollsofmaat.com

The Family Is The First Business. Build it. Protect it. Pass it down.